

How can you use strategy/outcomes diagrams to allow for politicians' outcomes, agencies' business-as-usual outcomes plus citizens' outcomes?

Politicians' outcomes, citizens' outcomes, and government's business-as-usual outcomes all have to be factored into outcomes frameworks for a government agency, provider, policy or initiative. How can you do this? When using DoView Planning, you can think of there being three sets of interrelated outcomes that can be drawn separately, or combined into a single integrated DoView diagram.

The first set is politicians' outcomes. These can be seen as simply a visually modeled elaboration of the politicians' party manifesto, but one that they regularly update in the course of being in government. Secondly, there is government agency's business-as-usual work - things that government agencies are required to do by law or convention. The last set of outcomes is citizens' outcomes. In an ideal world these citizens' outcomes should be broadly driving the other two sets of outcomes. These citizens' outcomes can be used help conceptually join-up government activity across multiple government agencies, providers, policies, and initiatives, even though this is not always the case. You can potentially combine any of these three sets of outcomes within a single DoView integrated strategy/outcomes diagram. If you do, then you can subsequently mark-up this integrated strategy/outcomes diagram with a current set of priorities that reflect politicians, business-as-usual and citizens' outcomes.

Government agency and provider activities (projects, programs, initiatives, and activities) can then be visually mapped onto the integrated (or separate) strategy/outcomes diagrams. The How An Initiative Can Deal With Multiple 'Outcomes Sets' Tool (B17) shows how to do this. Politicians and government chief executives can then quickly see: 1) that government agency work is tightly focused on politicians' priorities; 2) that government agencies are undertaking their business-as-usual work as is required of them; and, 3) that politicians and agencies are focusing on citizens' outcomes.

Building, and using, these sets of integrated or separate DoView strategy/outcomes diagrams within DoView Planning can be introduced over several years as agencies get used to working with the approach (see Section I).